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THURSDAY, MARCH 12, 2026

Who gets to buy a mobile home park?



GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Residents want to buy The Park at Pocasset.

In the state's highest court, two sides were facing off: the monied investment team in their dark, sleek suits, versus Al MacDonald, a retired general contractor in a hoodie, a 76-year-old man fighting to save his mobile home park.

"I started all this," he said after the hearing on March 2 before the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court, his breathing labored from a health condition. "I have to see it to

BETH TEITELL

COMMENTARY

the end."

The end. The beginning. A story that's touching down all over the country, as investors are buying up mobile home parks, eager to make a buck, or millions of them, off the poor, the elderly, the disabled, and their 15-foot-wide homes.

Mobile home parks command a lot of attention in our culture. They're crooned about in song, used in TV and film as shorthand for people of modest means. But many people don't know perhaps the single most important thing about them: While residents typically own their own homes, crucially they do not own the land beneath them.

TEITELL, Page A6

Judge tells ICE to free teenager

14-year-old girl was detained in Marlborough

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio and Marcela Rodrigues

GLOBE STAFF

A federal judge Wednesday ordered US immigration authorities to free a 14-year-old girl and return her from New York to Massachusetts after she was detained under questionable circumstances the day before in Marlborough.

The Department of Homeland Security on Wednesday had claimed its agents took the girl into custody to protect her from suspected gang members she was in a car with.

But her lawyer and the federal judge questioned why she was not turned over to state child welfare authorities, which is standard procedure.

Instead, after the girl was apprehended by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents in a parking lot, she was eventually transferred to New York and held by the Office of Refugee Resettlement, which handles custody of unaccompanied minors.

The lawyer for the teenager had petitioned the federal court for her release, and US District

ICE, Page A5

US blamed in school strike

An ongoing military investigation has determined that the United States is responsible for a deadly missile strike on an Iranian elementary school, according to US officials. **A4.**

Far-right leader José Antonio Kast was sworn in as Chile's new president, marking the Latin American nation's most pronounced shift to the right since the return of democracy in 1990. **A3.**

Governor Maura Healey said she wished she never hired a now-former aide after prosecutors said they found a digital scale with traces of drugs in his Springfield office. **B1.**

Sprinkle shows

Thursday: Cloudy, showers. High: 56-61. Low: 28-33.

Friday: Cooler, cloudy. High: 40-45. Low: 35-40. Sunrise: 7:01 Sunset: 6:47

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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A family story finally unveiled



By Tonya Alanez

GLOBE STAFF

Tamara Lanier's long odyssey to research her family tree all the way back to "Papa Renty," made in a promise to her dying mother 16 years ago, culminated Wednesday when historic photographs of her enslaved ancestors went on display to the public for the first time.

Lanier's relentless pursuit led to the improbable discovery of the striking images locked away at Harvard University. What followed was a six-year legal tug-of-war with the Ivy League school that paved the way for the exhibit at their new home, the International African American Museum in Charleston, S.C.

The 15 daguerreotypes of Papa Renty, his daughter, and five others are believed to be the earliest known images of enslaved people in the United States. They were originally taken 176 years ago by a Charleston photographer, Joseph T. Zealy, for a Harvard biologist researching a since-discredited theory of Black racial inferiority.

The public unveiling marked a homecoming of sorts for the

She fought Harvard to reclaim images of her enslaved ancestors. Her victory is now on display.

A daguerreotype of Renty Taylor, the great-great-great-grandfather of Tamara Lanier.

images, which were taken during the winter of 1850 in South Carolina.

"This is a major American milestone that I think we need to celebrate," Lanier, 63, the great-great-great-granddaughter of Renty, said in an interview from her home in Norwich, Conn. "This is the first time in the history of this country that the cultural property of an enslaved person is being repatriated back to their home community."

Lanier sued Harvard for the release of the images and the case went all the way to the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court. In 2022, the court ruled that while Harvard owned the images, Lanier could sue the school for emotional distress.

In December, the university handed over the images to the African American museum. The opening reception on Wednesday included a museum tour, a viewing of the daguerreotypes, and a press conference attended by Lanier, one of her daughters, a sister, her two lawyers, and other supporters.

"The full interpretation of

HARVARD, Page A7

Deal set on security money for World Cup

Kraft, soccer organizers say they have commitment to cover Foxborough's cost

By Michael Silverman

GLOBE STAFF

The high-stakes battle that pitted Foxborough against the governing body for international soccer, the Kraft Sports & Entertainment Group, and Boston's World Cup host committee is over.

And Foxborough won.

The two sides said late Wednesday they had reached a deal that satisfies Foxborough's request for \$7.8 million in advance to cover its share of security costs for the seven World Cup soccer games scheduled at Gillette Stadium beginning in June.

The town's Select Board had refused to grant the entertainment license that soccer's governing body, FIFA, needs to stage the World Cup in Foxborough.

The statement, bearing the logos of Boston's World Cup host committee, Kraft Sports & Entertainment, and the town, said they had reached an "understanding collectively" to "finalize the details" necessary for the town to approve an entertainment license.

The agreement said Foxborough "will not incur any cost or financial burden related to the FIFA World Cup, with Boston Soccer 2026 providing advance funding for security-related capital expenditures and the full extent of deployment

FOXBOROUGH, Page A7

As pot prices plunge, Mass. industry sags

Retailers find it hard to succeed in saturated market

By Bryan Hecht

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Grocery prices are rising. Rents are up. There is one product, though, that's actually getting cheaper: marijuana.

The price of a gram of weed — the amount in a large joint — was down to just above \$4, on average, in January, the latest continuation of a years-long nose-dive that has sent prices plummeting over 70 percent since pot stores first opened in Massachusetts in 2018. In those days, a gram cost more than \$14.

"I'm taking advantage definitely," Tori Wells, a Boston customer, said of current rock-bottom prices as she left downtown dispensary Pure Oasis one recent afternoon.

While consumers are happy, low prices have launched the industry into turmoil. It's a far cry from the visions of wealth in cannabis that laid the foundation for many entrepreneurs to enter the industry and the state's efforts at enriching Black and Latino communities that were targeted by the war on drugs.

"Profitability is tough to reach," said Gabriel Vieira, CEO of Zyp Run, the first cannabis deliv-

CANNABIS, Page A6

Marijuana sales in Massachusetts

